

IMAST Abstract Review Process

The purpose of this document is to clarify the review process and provide guidance for future IMAST and SRS meeting chairs. Abstract selection is a multi-layered process that initially uses a scoring system outlined below, as well as judgement from the program chairs and category leads. The scoring system is one component of inclusion in the program, including authorship and a balanced, overall program. Occasionally, a highly scored abstract may not be selected for a podium presentation due to the needs of the overall program.

To support the implementation of the review process, the program chairs will lead a web-based educational meeting to describe the review process and the specific focus of the meeting. The meeting will be recorded for all that cannot attend. Please review the steps of the review process below.

- 1) Abstract Review Process
 - a) Abstracts will be blinded during the initial review
 - b) Expectation is to review no more than 10 abstracts at a time and focus is to be on quality of content, study design, and innovation for the IMAST meeting
 - c) All blinded abstracts will be reviewed by 5-6 reviewers
 - d) New scoring total out of 15, with 5 points coming from each of the three categories
 - i) 1-5 quality of content
 - ii) 1-5 study design
 - iii) 1-5 innovation
 - e) A score of 1 is the best
 - f) Abstracts will be placed into a rank order based on Olympic score into each individual category
- 2) Category Review Process
 - a) Final rank list will be distributed to each of the category leads
 - b) Category leads will review all abstracts in their category independently (blinded)
 - c) Category leads required to have independent zoom meeting with their reviewers to determine preliminary selection and rank of abstracts
 - d) After this meeting, the unblinded list must be reviewed by category leads and re-organized based on authorship (no more than 2 abstracts per presenting author)
- 3) Final Review and Program Build
 - a) Program chairs (Meric Enercan and Kristen Jones) and Category Leads will hold a zoom meeting for program selection
 - b) Expectation is to have read through majority of the abstracts if in attendance on this call
 - c) All leads will have reviewed ALL abstracts from their category, rank them, and organize the program and sessions with their abstracts the way they see best
 - d) Document any rank order changes made for non-scoring reasons and the thought process of selection
- 4) Final program and selection of abstracts will be dictated by committee chairs and leads and based on the best abstracts that allow us to create the best, most well-rounded program
 - a) In some instances, higher scoring papers may not be selected for the podium
 - i) These papers will be considered for the E-Point poster program
 - b) SRS Staff will document the thought process of the selections and reasoning for any program changes